

CampusMart Setup Guide

This guide explains how to clone, install, seed, test, and run CampusMart on a new PC.

1. Requirements

- Python 3.12 or newer recommended
- Git
- Windows PowerShell or a terminal
- Internet connection for dependency installation and optional online features

2. Clone the Repository

```
git clone <repository-url>
cd campus_marketplace
```

Replace '<repository-url>' with the real GitHub repository URL.

3. Create a Virtual Environment

```
python -m venv .venv
```

Activate it:

```
.venv\Scripts\activate
```

If PowerShell blocks activation, run:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned
```

Then activate again.

4. Install Dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

5. Environment File

The project can run without a '.env' file because it has a local demo fallback key.

For a cleaner setup, create '.env' in the project root:

```
SECRET_KEY=replace-this-with-any-long-random-string-for-local-testing
```

6. Database Setup

Run migrations:

```
python manage.py migrate
```

7. Seed Demo Data

CampusMart includes a Django seeder-like command:

```
python manage.py seed_demo_data
```

It creates demo users and sample products. It is safe to run more than once.

Demo accounts:

Seller: demo_seller / demo12345

Buyer: demo_buyer / demo12345

8. Run Tests

```
python manage.py test
```

All tests should pass before demoing the app.

9. Start the Server

```
python manage.py runserver
```

Open:

<http://127.0.0.1:8000/>

10. Common Issues

If 'python' does not work, try:

```
py manage.py runserver
```

If dependencies are missing, make sure the virtual environment is activated and run:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

If the database looks empty, run:

```
python manage.py migrate
```

```
python manage.py seed_demo_data
```

If online images or converted prices do not appear, check the internet connection. The app still works without them.